

Book #3

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT
KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD
From the "DESIGN YOUR OWN SERIES"

Included pattern is adaptable to any waist and hip size.
Instructions are included for designing your own multi color jacquard
with knitted in pleats.



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"Knitware for All Reasons"

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ABOUT HUSKYTALK KNITWORKS

Our Siberian huskies are our faithful canine friends. In the summer they go backpacking with my husband and me, and in winter they take our grandchildren for sled rides. They insist we take them out daily for walks, and they keep us fit in the process. The Huskies don't usually bark. Instead they "talk," sometimes tuning up in a chorus.

The three form a trio of very entertaining "kids."

And so here's to the namesakes of HuskyTalk Knitworks ---
Indiana Jones, SugarLoaf's Dakota, and Skye Blue



I dedicate this book to the Generic Knitters of Boulder, Colorado.
I count you as faithful friends, great motivators, and a constant source of creative inspiration. It was because of you that this book was written at all.

Marcia

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

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Skirt with pleats hanging closed.
Notice that the pleats fall straight
down from hip line.



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GENERAL NOTES

- ✓ The pattern directions are for Japanese machines, but can be easily adapted to Passap Duomatics or the E6000. Creation 6 is a great "speeder-upper" for this process.
- ✓ Specific row by row directions have been written for the model skirt using a Brother machine. Instructions for adjusting size are in the knitting section of the leaflet.

MATERIALS, MACHINES AND TENSIONS

- ✓ I made the model skirt of a strand of JaggerSpun 2/20 heather wool run with a strand of serger thread for strength. I have also made a skirt of Delaine Delite, although the nubbinness of this yarn caused some problems in knitting on the double bed. Probably a smooth yarn, like Bramwell Silky is best for a first try. A four panel skirt like the model requires 16 oz (5600 yds) of each color, and 5600 yards of each color of serger thread.
- ✓ A standard gauge machine with a ribber and color changer are required. I used a Brother 950i machine with a Brother 900 ribber (with lili settings) and non-automatic color changer. (The lili settings allow every other needle selection on the ribber.)
- ✓ You will probably use a tension of 5/5 for most of the knitting. The cast on rows are critical. Check the tensions carefully on the swatch to be sure all stitches are knitting properly and tight enough.

- ✓ The process of splitting the color pattern into 6 pleat sections was done on the preview of DesignaKnit 6 ®.

HOW THE PLEATS ARE DONE -- DESIGNLIMITATIONS AND POSSIBILITIES

- ✓ The outside of each pleat is done with both beds working, and the multicolor design is produced on the main or back bed (on Japanese machines).
- ✓ The inside fold of each pleat is done completely on the front bed (ribber). There is no patterning on the ribber except for the lili button setting (the bird'seye effect). The pleat fold is the purl side.
- ✓ The design can be knit as 2 color jacquard, or as 3, 4, 5, or 6 color jacquard depending on the machine and on the stitch pattern you are using. (For example, the Brother CK 35 can be set up to knit this skirt in 6 color jacquard.) Most machines can do 4 color jacquard.
- ✓ The stitch design can be done on a 24st punch card machine or on the most sophisticated electronic model. A punch card machine will require the cards punched especially for multicolor jacquard designs.
- ✓ I have included at the back of the leaflet a quick and easy method of doing the skirt using one of the built-in patterns and the KRC setting on your electronic machine. This method will not have the overall design effect when the pleats hang closed, but it is still unique and quite attractive.

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- ✓ Read through all the design information before you start knitting, even though you will be using the pattern included as is. The design sections will help you understand what you are doing when you are setting up the pleats and trouble shooting any problems.

PLEASE TAKE NOTES!

Write a lot of notes — here, and in the margins, on the back side of pages, everywhere. Keep really accurate records of tension settings, gauges, yarns, and so forth, even if you don't use that yarn for this project.

READ THIS BEFORE YOU START KNITTING

- ☐ FP = full pitch on ribber -- needles are directly opposite each other
- ☐ HP = half pitch -- needles from main bed come halfway between needles of ribber bed
- ☐ Z = zig zag row knitted between main bed and ribber bed before hanging the ribber comb
- ☐ CX = Two passes of the knit/rib cam to make one round of circular knit -- may be 3 passes on Japanese machines to make 1 1/2 rounds
- ☐ 7 wires = wire weight hangers used with the ribber and shaped like the number "7"
- ☐ FNR = full needle rib with all needles working on both beds and the pitch lever set at half -- needles will not hit each other
- ☐ nd (s) = needle or needles on the machine
- ☐ st (s) = stitch or stitches
- ☐ stst = stockinette stitch
- ☐ TD = tension dial setting in numbers. TD 5/6 means tension dial is set at "5" on main bed and at "6" on ribber bed
- ☐ * = a "click" on tension dial (5 ** means tension 5 and 2 clicks)
- ☐ MT or GT = garment tension
- ☐ GT +2 = means garment tension plus 2 numbers
GT -2 = means garment tension minus 2 numbers
- ☐ lili = means lili buttons on ribber of some machines -- allows the ribber to select every other needle every other row to produce a tweed look on back of multi color jacquard

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A FEW MORE KNITTING TIPS

- ↳ I kept end needle selection on throughout the knitting. I like the edge it makes, and I feel as though the jacquard sections knit better if the end needles knit each row. Make samples of each, and use the one you like the best.
- ↳ memo window = The color number changes in the memo window as soon as the cam starts its return pass into the color changer at left. This means that you will see in the memo window the number of the color that you will use at the end of the row, not the number you are currently using. To prevent confusion, try to check the memo number only as you knit left.
- ↳ If you must stop knitting midway through piece, stop on the side opposite color changer. Then follow directions for starting and stopping your particular machine. When you start again, the memo will tell you which color to pick up when you get back to the color changer.
- ↳ Fine needle bar = The long thin plastic strip that goes under the main bed gate peg ledge on Japanese machines. Don't forget it! And be sure to put it in before knitting any samples.
- ↳ Transferring stitches from one bed to the other: It is helpful to put ribber on pitch setting. The needles are then opposite each other for the transfer, and it's easier to transfer to the correct needle. This way you won't have to keep track of ribber needle numbers, only main bed needles. **BE SURE TO PUT THE RIBBER BACK TO HALF PITCH BEFORE KNITTING!**

- ↳ There are two disks available — a DesignaKnit™ disk and a Brother PPD disk with the same designs.
 - The Brother PPD disk can be used for any Brother or KnitKing machine, including the Brother CK35. The design requires the memory capacity of a Brother 940 machine.
 - The DesignaKnit™ disk has four patterns. Two patterns are the stitch pattern in unsplit form and six pleat split form for Japanese machines with 200 needles. The third and fourth patterns are stitch patterns for five pleats as might be used on a Passap machine with 180 needles.

A stitch pattern template, already laid out with the pleat separation, is available from HuskyTalk Knitworks. Please inquire. The template is suited to copying directly onto the mylar design sheets intended for Brother and Studio machines that will read over 200 needles. The template can also be used for key entry into the machine.

The disk that is currently available is on a CD and is designed for use in DesignaKnit 5 or later. The disk contains the model skirt in its unsplit form, the design with the pleats inserted, and two patterns for the Passap (5 pleats).

The skirt patterns are also saved as fairisle format. Use the patterns with the double jacquard setting on your electronic machine.

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↪ The Concept that makes this skirt design possible is the use of double bed knitting to form the face of the pleats, while moving all the stitches for the inside of the pleat fold to the ribber bed.

↪ Background and Foreground colors: Be very careful of this — it's very easy to get them switched. If you do —

- Electronic machines usually have a negative switch. When this is set, the nds for background color select instead of nds for the contrast color. On most machines this will work to effectively switch your colors. Be sure to check it on a swatch first. If you switch color numbers, rethread the color changer to match the new selection.
- Another alternative: Switch colors in color changer, and reallocate colors on any design program you may be using.
- On a punch card machine, switching colors in the color changer is the easiest method. Punch cards must be repunched anytime one makes a change in background/foreground colors.
- Machines that read only from a mylar card (older Studio and Brother machines that do not accept a disk drive) will have a switch to reverse needle selection. If not, you will have to remake the card. Be sure to also mark the prompt column with the correct color sequence.

↪ Main Bed Needles are in work only in sections marked. These are the sections that form the face of the pleats. All the ribber needles are working throughout. The ribber stitches that have no corresponding main bed stitches form the inside fold of the pleats. If you are using a ribber setting that produces “bird’s eye” fabric on the back of the knitting, the inside of the pleats will have a tweed look.

↪ The pattern stitch design can also be entered into your machine—

- by using the black/white data keys on some machines
- by using draw keys on PPD according to the design print out. From the PPD the design can be transferred directly to machine or stored on disk.
- by copying the design onto the mylar cards

Just a Note:

If you would like to see a similar skirt, but with jacket and camisole to complete an outfit, see the Winter 1990 issue of ZaZa magazine. The magazine was published by Nihon Vogue and was imported most recently by Krüh Knits. The concept of the pleats is the same, or at least similar. The stitch pattern is quite different.

I have tried to contact Nihon Vogue directly for permission to show the photos of their suit. The University of Colorado Norlin Library was able to locate an address and fax number. However, at this time, there has been no response.

Many knit shops stocked this magazine, and kept library copies. Locate that issue, if you can. You will find it well worth it.

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

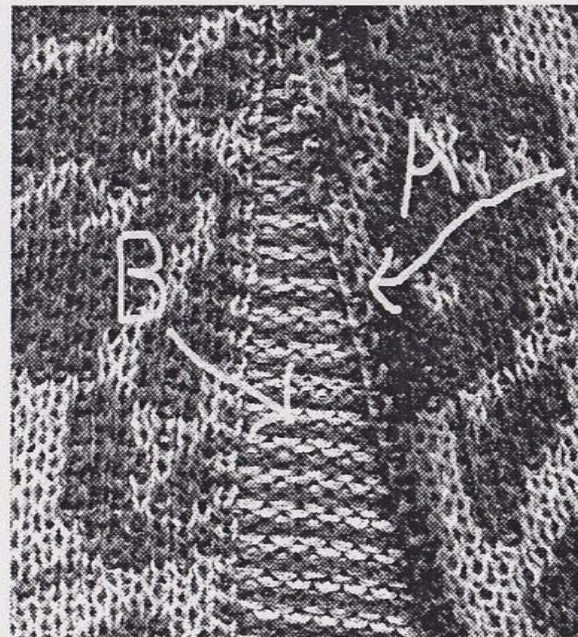
KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

DRAWING YOUR OWN STITCH PATTERN

- ↳ These Instructions are calculated for a 200 stitch needle bed.
- If your machine has fewer stitches available, you will need to readjust the stitches contained in each pleat outside and in each hidden pleat fold.
- In recalculating, you may find that you will use fewer pleats in each panel knitted. Do not make the outside of the pleat less than 17 sts or the pleat fold less than 16 sts. Rather than changing the number of stitches in the pleats, change the number of pleats made per skirt panel.
 - This will mean redrawing the stitch pattern so that the pattern repeats at five pleats instead of six. Directions for separating the pleat sections are detailed later in this section.
- ↳ If you don't have a computer design program, try drawing your design on the design sheets for the mylar cards. The stitches and rows are in proportion. Tape together as many sheets as you need for your design.
- After the design is drawn, cut the stitch columns apart between stitches 18-19, 35-36, 52-53, 69-70, 86-87. Separate the stitch sections by 16-20 sts, realign them, and trace with the blank areas inserted. This pattern can also be used to enter the design on a PPD or with key entry.
 - Depending on your machine, you may be limited to a 60 st repeat. By using the mirror function, you can use a 120 st design with 120 nds working. This will make 3 pleats of 19 st on the face and 18 st in the fold, which is also a good pleat size.

↳ End needle selection: On Brother machines KCI selects end needles and KCII does not (used for single motif knitting).

- When end needles select on this pattern, there will be an edge on each pleat section because the double knit is followed by a section of empty nds on the main bed. The edge looks like a vertical stitch column of both colors alternating. In photo below arrow A points to the edge, and arrow B points to the tweed inside of the pleat fold.



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↳ If you used 200 needles in your swatch, your swatch should have 6 sections that form the outside (patterned) part of the pleats. You will have 5 complete inside sections for the pleats plus one inside section on the right that will have one or two extra seam stitches.

- First calculate how many stitches are needed for the front side of the pleats. On 200 needle machines the best configuration is 17 stitches for the front of each pleat and 16 stitches for the inside fold of each. You might change last needle on ribber bed on right to a main bed needle, just to make knitting a little easier. Look at the needle bed set up for the pleats to see why this might be helpful.
- Draw a pattern of 102 stitches (17sts x 6 pleats) by however many rows you need that repeat in all directions. For double jacquard you must have an even number of rows in the design. The design to the right was drawn in this manner in DesignaKnit and saved as a separate pattern. You can go back and use it again, if you mess up the next step.
- Starting at the left, insert sections of 16 stitches by (?) rows at stitches 19, stitch 52, stitch 86, stitch 119, and stitch 152. (Stitches 185 to 200 will be blank.) This configuration allows 18 stitches on the left so there is an extra seam stitch. You can also leave the first needle on the left empty and the last needle on right empty for an even number stitch set up on the ribber. (for bird's eye)

↳ The resulting pleated fabric for the model skirt will look like picture below. This is also the way the unsplit stitch pattern looks. You can see that the idea is to keep the stitch pattern intact while inserting plain fabric for the pleat folds. The fabric with the pleats folded has a stitch design that repeats in all directions.

- If you have a computer scanner, try scanning the picture below into Cochenille Stitch Painter or DesignaKnit, and prepare the design from there.

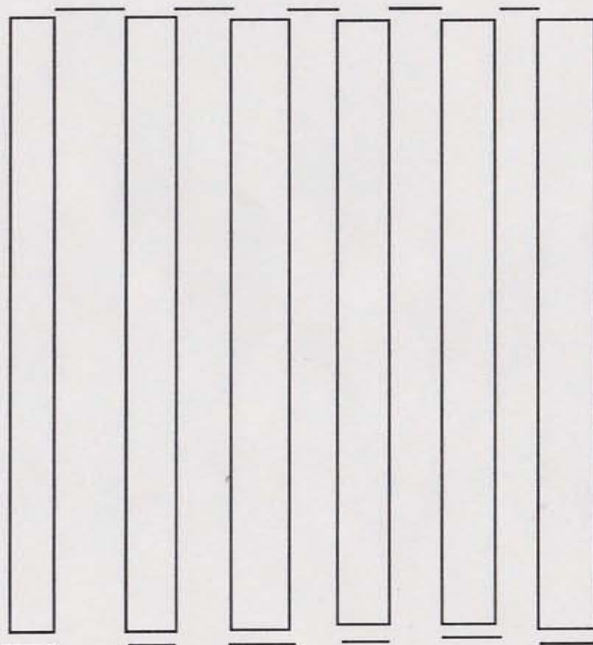
102+1 stitches by 200rs — repeats in all directions



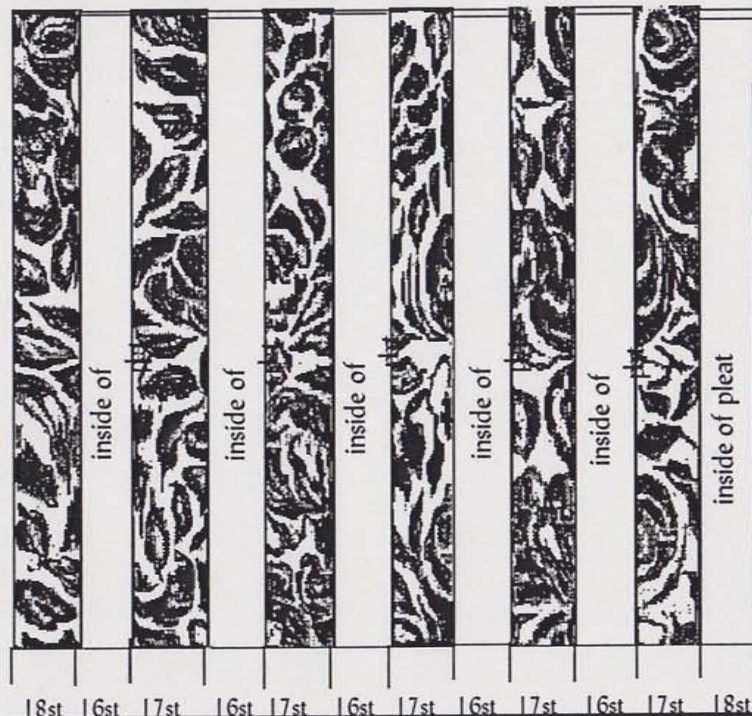
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Make Your Own Notes and Diagrams Here



This is the way the pattern looks after it is split into pleat sections. The original pattern, unsplit, is on page 6. (PPD and disk pattern 902)



- ☐ 97 stitches in the six inside folds. This is 6 folds times 16 stitches plus 1 seam stitch at right.
- ☐ 103 stitches in the pleat fronts. This is 17 stitches X 6 pleats plus a seam stitch in front of pleat at left.
- ☐ The total is 200 stitches. Make this 198 if you like. Or use 199 with the empty main bed needle on the main bed on the right, if you do not need an even number of needles. The extra needle more or less doesn't matter.



keep going!

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↪ This is how the pattern looks after the stitch columns have been inserted. Notice that the numbering goes from left to right instead of center to left and center to right. If you are designing your own stitch pattern, you will need these numbers in this order to insert the blank areas.

↪ The layout on page 14 is the same as this, but it is translated into a centered numbering to correspond to the machine needle bed. These two layouts must match or the folded pleats will not have a continuous design.

(1-18)		(19-35)		(36-52)	
double jacquard	ribber bed only	double jacquard	ribber bed only	double jacquard	ribber bed only
1 - 18	<u>19 - 34</u>	35 - 51	<u>52 - 67</u>	68 - 85	<u>86 - 101</u>

☐ You can check that all is correct by doing a “dry run” on the machine needle bed. Put all main bed needles in work, program pattern, and run cam across. Count the main bed needles that don’t select to be sure of position of plain fabric.

☐ Another more visual way to check is to knit a single bed fabric with the pattern center engaged. There will be long floats in the plain fabric parts, but the fabric should look like the illustration on page 8. When folded, it should look like the one on page 7. Try it! You will gain a lot of confidence before tackling the double bed part.

(53-69)		(70-86)		(87-102)	
double jacquard	ribber bed only	double jacquard	ribber bed only	double jacquard	ribber bed only
102 - 118		135 - 151		168 - 184	
119 - 134		152 - 167		185 - 200	

↪ Where the blank areas go: Note the numbers in parentheses above the double jacquard sections. These are the numbers you will need to place the pattern sections and the blank sections of the finished pattern. For example: Stitches 53-69 will become stitches 102-118 on the final split pattern. This will be explained in detail in last section on use of the pattern program device.

↪ You're doing great!

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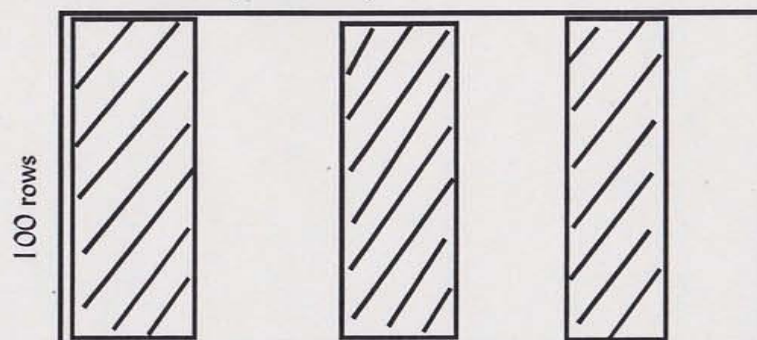


THE INFAMOUS SWATCH

Yes, you must make a swatch, but it will be a little different than usual. The good news is that the swatch will do double duty. Here's the basic idea --

1. Choose one of the cast on methods from pages 12 or 13 and cast on over needles 52L to 52 R.
2. Watch the cast on rows carefully. If the machine seems to be grinding, or stitches sticking, try different tension settings. When you find the settings that seem to work, start over and this time set up the pleats and go on into your pattern according to directions.
3. After about 30 rows of pattern, stand on your head if necessary, to check the back side of the pattern for correct colors, patterning, and possible dropping stitches. Is your fine needle bar in place?
4. If the pattern and all else seem to be correct at that point, continue knitting to 100 pattern rows. Move all stitches to the main bed. Remember that the pleat inside fold will have only ribber stitches and the pleat fronts will already have a main bed stitch to which you will add the ribber stitch. Knit two rows of stockinette in the planned color for the waist band. Then knit an inch or so of scrap yarn. Remove from machine.

104 stitches (52L to 52R)



5. Fold in and pin the pleats on the swatch, and press. Use a wool setting on wool, and press as though you were pressing pleats into a wool fabric. If the yarn is synthetic, Kill It! If the pleated fabric doesn't look the way you want it to look, try different tensions to get the "hand" in the fabric that you want. If you still don't like it, use the yarn for something else, but abandon it for this project. The pleats must look right on the swatch.

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USE THE SWATCH THIS WAY --

↳ First — measure the length of the 100 pattern rows including the cast-on rows. Calculate how many rows it takes to make one inch and multiply that by the length in inches for the skirt. My skirt length is 31" and the swatch calculated to 18 rows per inch. I need 31 X 18 for the row count (558 rows).

✓ Don't worry about the extra rows past the 400 pattern rows. The pattern is designed to repeat in all directions (thanks to the *shuffle* part of the DesignaKnit® program). Also, the rows that show on the row counter will be the same as the pattern rows until the second vertical repeat starts.

✓ For example, on my skirt the final row count will be 558. The pattern rows will be 158 rows into the second repeat. On this pattern, the machine row count and stitch pattern row will be the same through row 400. There are actually 4 passes of the cam for every 2 rows of the pattern, but the stitch pattern numbers every row. This is different from the usual jacquard row count set-up, and I hope you won't be confused.

↳ Second — Knit an entire skirt panel. You know you need at least two panels, and the chances are that this one will be just right. Press the panel and hang it unweighted for a day or so to make sure the length is right. These pleats don't change much even when hung with weights.

↳ Third — Practice hanging the pleats on the small swatch back onto the needle bed in preparation for the waist band. If you used the racking cast on method, practice pulling the loops through to form a neat bottom edge. Check stitch/row gauge for stockinette stitch in waistband. Use two strands of waistband color.

✓ Make copies of the page with the cast-on method you have chosen—one for each panel you will knit — and use the copy to check off the boxes as you do each procedure. The knitting of these skirt panels is tricky, particularly the cast-on. You must concentrate and carefully monitor stitches. Look for stitches caught on the needle heads, or stitches that didn't knit off. Once you have 10 rows or so of the pattern knitted, you will find it going faster.

✓ The two methods for casting on the stitches follow on the next pages.

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STANDARD RIBBER CAST ON

- ☐ Arrange needles (nds) for full needle rib (FNR). Use an even number of nds so that you are prepared for the lili setting later. I used 198, but do not use less, except to make a panel with less than 6 pleats. On Brother machines, check for the even number needles setting on the ribber. There is a straight mark on the needle number tape for every other needle. One end needle should be on the mark, and the other end should be off the mark.
- ☐ Thread the yarns, including scrap yarn, into the appropriate feeders in the color changer and anchor on bottom of ribber in usual way. Move cam to left into the color changer.
- ☐ TD @ 0/0 slide lever @ II, take color 1 and knit to right to form the zig zag row. Hang comb and the little weights. Be careful with weights on these first rows, as the weight can put too much tension on the stitches and cause thread to break.
- ☐ Set the cams for circular knit and tensions at the garment tension minus 2 numbers on both cams. (GT-2/GT-2). I set the left (<) part on the main cam and the right (>) PR on the ribber so that the first row knitting to the left is on the ribber bed. Knit the two passes of the circular rows, ending with COR.
- ☐ Set both cams for normal knit and garment tension. Now hang the heavier weights. Knit to left into the color changer and past the turn mark.
- ☐ Set up the pleats according to the diagram on page 14, pulling the nds to hold as you move sts from main bed to ribber. This will help the sts to knit off cleanly.
- ☐ Program pattern. See note on end needle selection, page 6. Machine is set for all-over pattern. DO NOT SET THE KRC BUTTON. Set cam to select the pattern nds. Color 1 should still be in the cam and the cam is still in the color changer. Row counter at 000. Knit to right. This row will be a bit "bumpy" as the cam goes from double bed knit to sections of ribber only.
- ☐ COR — Set the cams for double bed pattern knitting. On Brother machines this will be both parts set on main cam (< >). On ribber raise both PR levers, P/R lever on R, set lili knobs, and put slide lever in middle position. Knit to left. As soon as the cam moves < left, the memo window should show color 2, as that is the color to be used on the next pass.
- ☐ Proceed with double jacquard knitting. Remember that the machine row count and pattern row will always match through first 400 rows.
- ☐ Watch the first 30 rows or so carefully. Especially check every row to be sure that the comb isn't hung up on protrusions under the machine. If cam seems bumpy, check that you are on half pitch.

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*RACKING CAST ON*

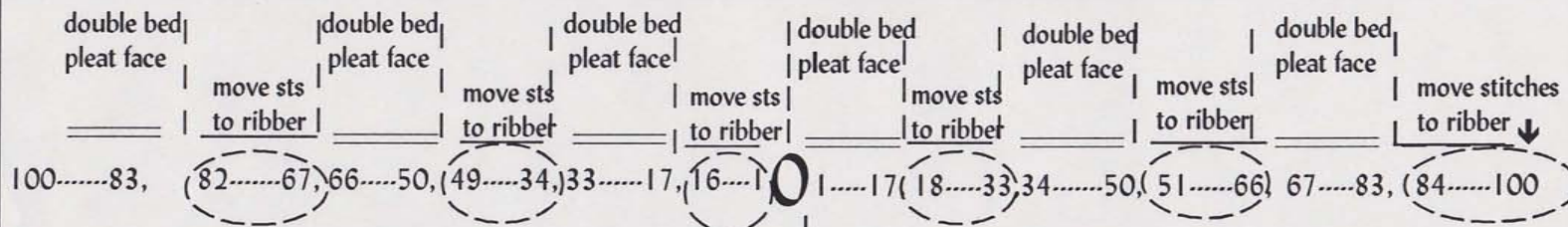
I prefer this cast-on, but you must take time to finish the edge. See illustration and note on page 21. Plan on one hour per skirt panel, and do not finish until all seams have been sewn.

- ☐ Do not use lili setting until told to do so!
- ☐ Thread yarns into proper feeders, and anchor to underside of ribber as usual. Use garment tension from start. Rack lever should be on #5. Have cam at left in color changer with color 1 ready to knit.
- ☐ Arrange nds as standard for FNR. Ignore odd and even numbers of nds until later. Rack one number either direction. (Remember which way that is — or write it down, just in case!) Knit one row to right (Z row). Hang comb, and little weights.
- ☐ Rack back one number to the original position. The nds and comb will look strange, but don't worry. Knit back to left into the color changer to form the first row of FNR.

- ☐ Push cam (don't change color changer) past turn mark on left. Set up pleats as shown on page 14, pulling ribber nds to hold as you go. At this point raise or lower ribber nds to come out with an even number for the lili setting.
- ☐ Program pattern. See note on end needle selection. Machine is set for all-over pattern. DO NOT SET THE KRC BUTTON. Set cam to select the pattern nds. Color 1 should still be in the cam and the cam is still in the color changer. Row counter at 000. Knit to right. This row will be a bit "bumpy" as the cam goes from double bed knit to sections of ribber only.
- ☐ COR — Set the cams for double bed pattern knitting. On Brother machines this will be both parts set on main cam (< >). On ribber raise both PR buttons, set lili buttons, and put slide lever in middle position. Knit to left. As soon as the cam moves <, the memo window should show color 2, as that is the color to be used on the next pass.
- ☐ Proceed with double jacquard knitting. Remember that the machine row count and pattern row will always match through first 400 rows.
- ☐ Watch the first 30 rows or so carefully. Especially check every row to be sure that the comb isn't hung up on protrusions under the machine. If cam seems bumpy, check that you are on half pitch. Check that background color and contrast color are what you planned.



PLEAT SET-UP STARTING FROM CENTER AND WORKING TO LEFT AND RIGHT



Transfer stitches from main bed needles to ribber

bed needles in sections with single line over the numbers.

- ☐ To help find those needle numbers, they are also circled by a dashed line. When making the transfer, bring the ribber bed needle that now has two stitches on it, to the hold position (all the way up). When finished with the transfer, bring the remaining ribber needles to hold. Having the ribber bed needles in "hold" will help long sections of ribber bed needles knit off cleanly. Note that you cannot use this method if the lili buttons are operating.
- ☐ If you put ribber in pitch position to line up nds for easier transfer, put it back to HP before knitting!
- ☐ Example: Transfer stitches on main bed needles 18 R through 33 R to the ribber bed, R 51--66, and R84 -- 99. Also transfer L1--16, L34--49, L67--82.
- ☐ Note that needles R84 to R100 are empty on the main bed. For ease in knitting, it helps to have needle R100 on main bed working.

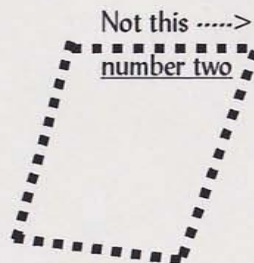
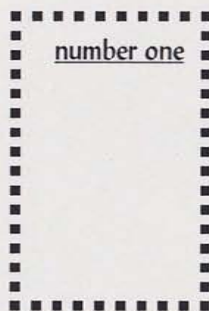
Knit and Measure the First Panel:

- ☐ Start with the cast-on method that you have chosen. I hope you have tried both methods and knit a few rows of the pleat design before deciding.
- ☐ You will have a row count for your skirt length that you have figured from the 100 row swatch. Knit to your required rows. Be sure to check frequently that all stitches are knitting off properly and that the fairaisle pattern is knitting correctly -- no stripes please! And yes, get down on the floor to be absolutely certain that the design is there.
- ☐ At the required row count, transfer all the stitches to the main bed. Pull all the main bed needles all the way forward to E or D position before each row, and knit 2 rows of stockinette stitch in the chosen waistband color.

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

- ☐ Knit at least 2 inches worth of scrap yarn and then remove piece from machine. You should have a fabric that looks like the illustration on page 6. The 2 color jacquard part of the fabric should show the floral pattern quite clearly. The inside fold of the pleats should be a tweedy looking stripe.
- ☐ Lay the fabric out on a pressing board or ironing board.
- ☐ Press the piece, the only requirement being that you keep it squared at the corners. Be sure the hem edge is even. You will probably need to use a blocking wire. The pressed piece should be a rectangle like number one below. Be sure the width of the piece with the pleats folded into place is the same as the width of the swatch. This width will determine the final fit at the hip line.



- ☐ If the panel looks like #2, the pleats will hang at an awkward angle. The yarn may be causing the bias, such as cotton sometimes does. If you can't get the piece to remain square after pressing, you will have to try a different yarn. Unfortunately, this kind of problem may not show up on the smaller swatch.
- ☐ When the piece is pressed nice and flat, fold in the pleats and pin them with heat resistant pins or safety pins. The pleats can go either way. Be consistent. Press the panel again, this time pressing in the pleats. Check that the hem is even in the folds. You can also run a binding wire through all thicknesses of the pleat folds to help get everything straight and even. *Do not finish the hem edge at this point if you chose the racking cast-on.*
- ☐ Suspend the panel from a skirt hanger overnight so that the panel stretches out to the fullest length. Do not hang weights! This panel is like an extended swatch. If the length isn't right, you will need to plan for adjustments now.



keep going!

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

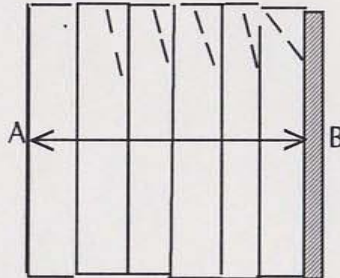
LAYOUT and PLANNING — waist, hip, length, etc.

- ☐ Length note: All length adjustments must be made at the waist edge.

> **SHORTEN:** An inch or so can be hidden in a waistband sewn on in a separate step. If you hang the waistband, the length will need to be exact. The easiest method is to use a cut and sew waist, and shorten as much as you need.

> **LENGTHEN:** Extra length can be had by making the waistband deeper, and by bringing the folded edge on the inside above the skirt/band joining point. This gives a shallow yoke effect on the front. If you need more than an inch, it's probably best to redo the whole panel, adding the needed length. You may not be able to reclaim the yarn. I hope you don't run out!

- ☐ After the pleated panel has had a chance to "hang out," lay it out flat on a table (on a sheet, so it can't slide around), and measure the width from the left edge to the fold of the right-most pleat. (A to B in diagram below)



- ☐ You will be measuring across 6 pleats -- not including the last portion that will be folded under.

- ☐ Figure your hip measure plus 2 inches, and divide that by the measure of the 6 pleats.

Ex. A to B measures 12" on my skirt

My hip measure is 44" plus 4" = 48"

48" divided by 12" = 4 (4) panels

- ☐ I will need 4 panels for my skirt. The extra fabric at the waist line can be eased underneath the pleats where the dashed lines are on the diagram at left.

- ☐ Always use more pleats than you think you need. The pleats must lie absolutely flat across the hip, or the skirt will not hang nicely. And there is no way to add width after the fact in the pleats. Extra fabric, however, can be hidden.

↳ Another example: Hip is 46" + 4" = 50"

50" divided by 12" = 4.2 (Probably use 5 panels, or 4 whole panels + 2 pleats in a 5th panel. The decision will depend on the waist/hip ratio. If waist is 36" with a 46" hip, use 5 panels.)

↳ What If Waist Is More Than 10" Smaller Than Hip?

First, necessarily there will be some extra bulk in the waist. The good news is that the bulk will not be as noticeable as one might think. Double or triple the stitches into about 8" worth of waistband needles. Extra fullness beyond this amount can usually be taken up with the elastic in the waistband.

DESIGN YOUR OWN -- LEAFLET # 3
THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT
KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD



PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

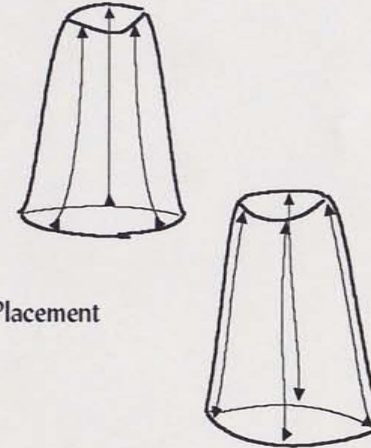
↳ Seam the Panels Together:

Seam methods vary, and it's important to make the seam invisible. I found it easiest to seam this way --- look at picture page 21.

- ☐ Lay the edge of the double knit part of the pleat on top of the edge of the inside fold. The edge of the fold should have a beaded kind of look with the colors alternating every two rows.
- ☐ Sew from the front side with an invisible whip stitch along the edge of the inside fold. Use the beaded edge of the double knit to hide the stitches.
- ☐ When all the seams are sewn, press the seam portions of the skirt flat again. Then press in the folds as they were before.

↳ Plan the Skirt Seam/Waist Layout

- ☐ Sew all the skirt seams before hanging the pleats to do the waist band sections. I found this method to be the easiest way to get the seams into place inside the pleat so the seam doesn't make a bump at the waist band.



Possible Seam Placement

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

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- ☐ If you have an uneven number of panels, it's best (but not necessary) to place the skirt seams in such a way that they do not fall at center front. A three panel skirt can have the seams on the side fronts, but will have a seam at center back.
- ☐ A four panel skirt could have the seams on side fronts and side backs. Use your judgement on your particular fabric as to how much difference seam placement makes.
- ☐ You should be able to make the waist band in two sections, assuming that you will double up stitches and overlap the pleats an extra amount at the waist to reduce bulk.
- ☐ Check the number of waist band stitches this way: Take the total waist measure plus 2 inches. (Mine is 34" + 2" or 36") Divide this total measure into two parts (mine is 18"). Hold a tape measure up to the needle bed of your machine, centered (mine is 9" each side of 0), and pull that number of needles forward to D position. It happens that 9" is about 50 nds, or about 100 nds for two panels.
- ☐ Unless the waist/hip difference is considerably more or less than the average 10 inches, the number of skirt panels needed for the hip should work out to a 50 stitches per panel set-up for the waist when the stitches are mostly doubled.



Another way to do the waist: Don't attempt to reduce bulk at waist, but rather hang pleats and then waist band, according to the actual stitches in fabric. Use elastic to gather in the fullness. This is a very good way to do the waist when the waist is less than 8 inches smaller than hip. See diagram on next page for stitch by stitch hanging of the pleats.

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

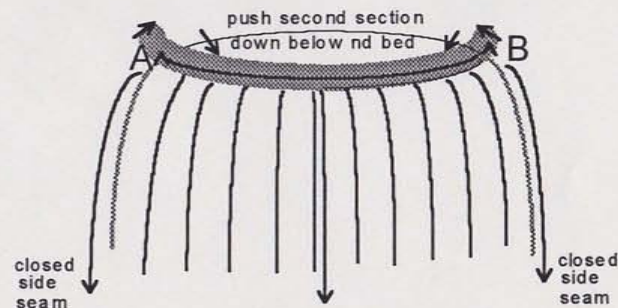
KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

When the band is brought to front and bound off, it has a chain stitch appearance along the edge. See white arrow.



↪ Hang the front section of skirt from A to B, in whatever seam arrangement you have chosen. Hold the pinned pleats right side toward you and hang pleats according to directions next page. Push the other half of skirt waist down behind needle bed. Hang double stitches from skirt at points A and B to keep stitches from stretching because of the weight.

✓ If cam is at right (at B), "e" wrap 3 stitches extra at edge A with waistband yarn. Then continue to knit row by hand through all pleat stitches to point B. "e" wrap an extra 3 stitches at edge B. These extra stitches will be the waist band seam later. Cam is at right ready to take yarn you have just used to hand knit. Follow knitting instructions on page 21 for remainder of band.



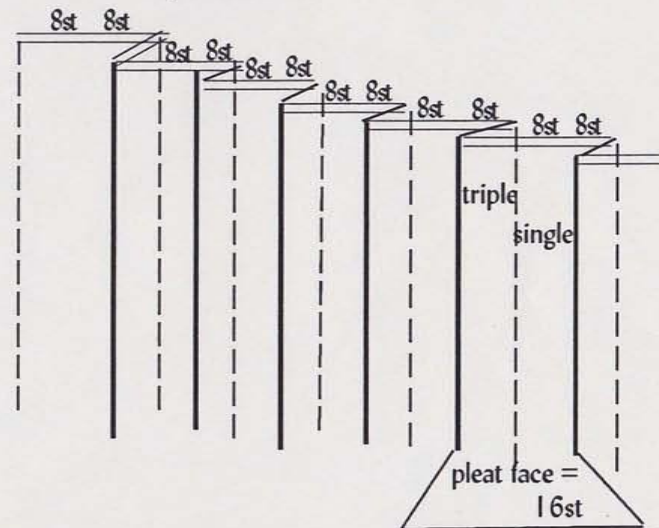
right side facing you
Hang pleats from A to B.

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- ☐ Fold the pleats in place and secure with pins about 2" below scrap yarn. Hold the pleated fabric with the right side toward you, and hang stitches on about every 4th nd across entire pleated fabric for space needed to hang half the skirt to half the waistband. You may need to remove these stitches later to hang stitches that should be underneath, but you need to get the spacing even.
 - ☐ Hang the stitches of the pleat inside fold onto the machine needles first. Double or triple stitches to reduce bulk, and try to end up with about 8 sts for each pleat face.
 - ☐ Next hang the second half of the inside fold on top of the first layer. Then hang the last layer of the pleat face. The next pleat face should be brought slightly over the edge of the inside fold to hide it. Be sure the pleat edge is always kept on that beaded edge formed at the junction of the single knit fabric with the double knit fabric.
 - ☐ Divide the total waist into front and back, with seams placed at center back and side fronts. Hang the pleats as described, from side point to side point. Be sure to allow 2 st for each seam on the waist band.
 - ☐ When you have half the pleats hung for half the band, knit the waist band for that section. Go on to second half of skirt.
- ↳ Alternate: Sew pleats in place with a sewing machine. A serged edge seems to be quite bulky, but can be used. Finish with your favorite cut and sew band.

- ↳ Finish Belt: Sew one side seam of belt closed, being sure to neaten up the joining of skirt seam and belt seam.
- ✓ Thread 3/4" elastic through the belt and adjust to waist size. Sew elastic closed, and then sew seam closed.
 - ✓ Especially if you have a seam at center back, you might wish to have a label or marker for the back so you can find it easily to put on.
- ↳ Another way to hang the pleats: Don't attempt to reduce bulk at waist, but rather hang pleats stitch for stitch. See illustration below. This will need 96 sts in band for 6 pleats. Use the elastic inside band to reduce size to waist measure.
- ☐ Important! Be sure the pleat face edge really does cover the edge of the fold.

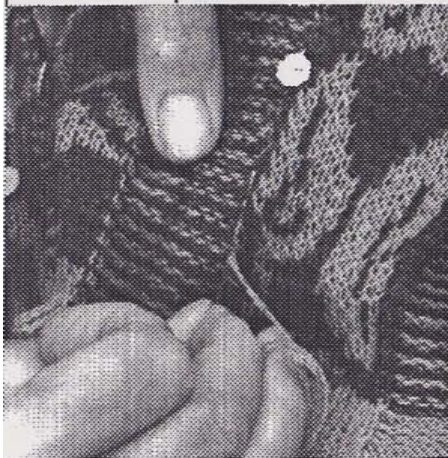


THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

Knit Waistband

- ✓ Use 2 strands of the yarn used for the skirt. The gauge should be about 8st and 10 rs to the inch, at the garment tension plus 3 numbers. Check this before you hang the skirt waist.
- ✓ With the skirt hung with right side facing you, knit first row by hand (most needles will have 2-6 st). Then knit 11 rows, 1 row at 10***, then 12 rows.
- ✓ Pick up the stitches of the first row of the waist band. The stitches should be easy to see without a marker row because it is the first row across all the pleats.
- ✓ Use latch tool to bind off the two layers of stitches for the waist band. This will produce a row of chain stitches on the right side of skirt. The chain stitches make a nice line of demarcation from the pleats.
- ⇒ Optional: You can tack down the pleats from the waist to the hip area.

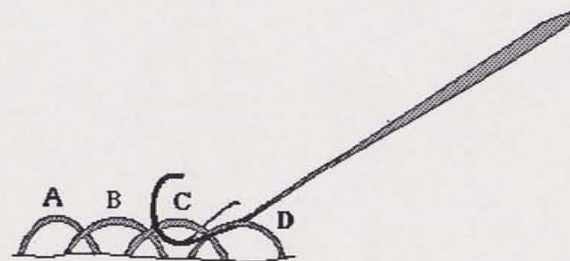


Sewing Seams: Notice that the pleat face is laid on top of the fold. The needle is run along edge of pleat face.

Use the same seam technique for sewing pleats closed from waist to hip.

Finish hem

- If you used the standard sledge edge cast on, you will not need to do any more finishing. A blocking wire run through the hem edge of the pleats helps to keep the folds even when steaming.
- If you used the racking cast on, finish the hem after all the seams are sewn:
- ✓ With a latch hook, pull one of the edge loops through the next in a continuous action around the hem. This will take some time, about an hour for each panel of pleats, but the edge looks like a row of crochet slip stitches.
- ✓ Pull loop C thru loop D -- C is on hook. Pull loop B thru loop C -- B is on hook. Pull loop A thru loop B -- A is on hook, and so forth.



THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

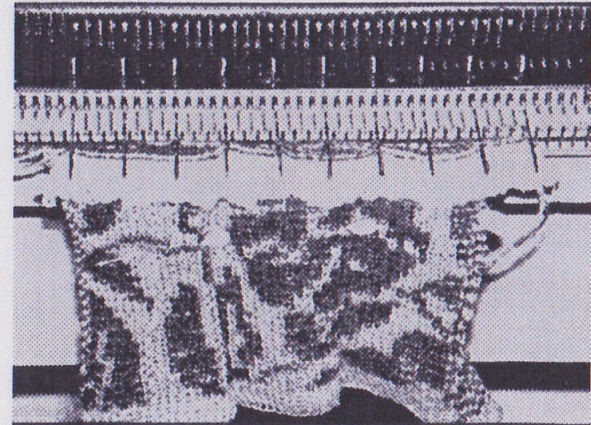
KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

The pleats pinned in place in preparation for hanging on machine. Notice the line of fabric stitches outlined by the waste yarn. The stitches that you will be picking up are brought to the side toward you so that you can find them more easily.



Pleats pinned in place with scrap yarn and ready to hang. Purl side will be facing, as in picture at right.

The pleats are spaced on the machine needles. Notice that stitches are hung on every fourth needle. The placement will depend partly on the relationship between the number of needles in one half of waistband to the number of stitches overlapped in pleats.



THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

DO YOU WANT TO USE THE PPD?

If you have a Pattern Programming Device (a Brother accessory), you can use it easily to split a stitch pattern into the pleat layout. You will begin the split from the right side of the pattern, moving one section at a time to the right as seen in the diagram page 24.

➤ First, you must create two new patterns on the PPD, and note the numbers assigned to each by the PPD.

☐ The first pattern will be a blank grid of 200 stitches by at least 100 rows.

☐ The second pattern will be your own design. You can —

✓ Use a large design that repeats in all directions over 103 stitches and needed rows. The number of rows doesn't matter, as you will use however many repeats you need for the skirt length.

✓ Or you can use a small design that repeats evenly in 102 stitches, and tile the design to cover the 103 stitch pattern area. The 103rd stitch will be a seam stitch.

✓ The design could be multiples of a 51 stitch, 34 stitch, or a 17 stitch pattern. It's reasonably easy to take a 49 or 52 stitch design and modify it to make a 51 stitch multiple. The same is true of designs close to 34 stitches or 17 stitches.

➤ Open the blank grid of 200 st by 200 rows.

✓ The cursor is at 1, 1.

✓ You will first import the entire design that you created into the blank grid, lining up the lower left corners.

☐ *Help menu —select 7—load stored pattern (step)*

choose from 1. built-in pattern
2. select character
3. external memory

—I used #1—

You will see (under selection #1)

1. created pattern
2. Stitch World
3. KH 270

—I used #1 —created pattern—

I also used #3 (reduce) from selection at bottom of screen to make sure I have the correct pattern. (The design is very large.)

☐ *Choose #1 —all—you will see empty grid (step)* Wait a few seconds for design to appear. You can check placement of the pattern by using *help—transfer cursor to row 1, stitch 104* (should be stitch immediately to the right of last pattern stitch)

☐ *Start moving sections into the grid at the right edge. The sections will be as below:*
[1-18] [19-35] [36-52] [53-69] [70-86] [87-103]

☐ *Help menu: #9 transfer pattern (step)*

#3 reduce—arrow to last section on right (step)

set corner—use arrow keys to move lower left corner to row 1, stitch 87 (step)

THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

A small square appears at lower left corner

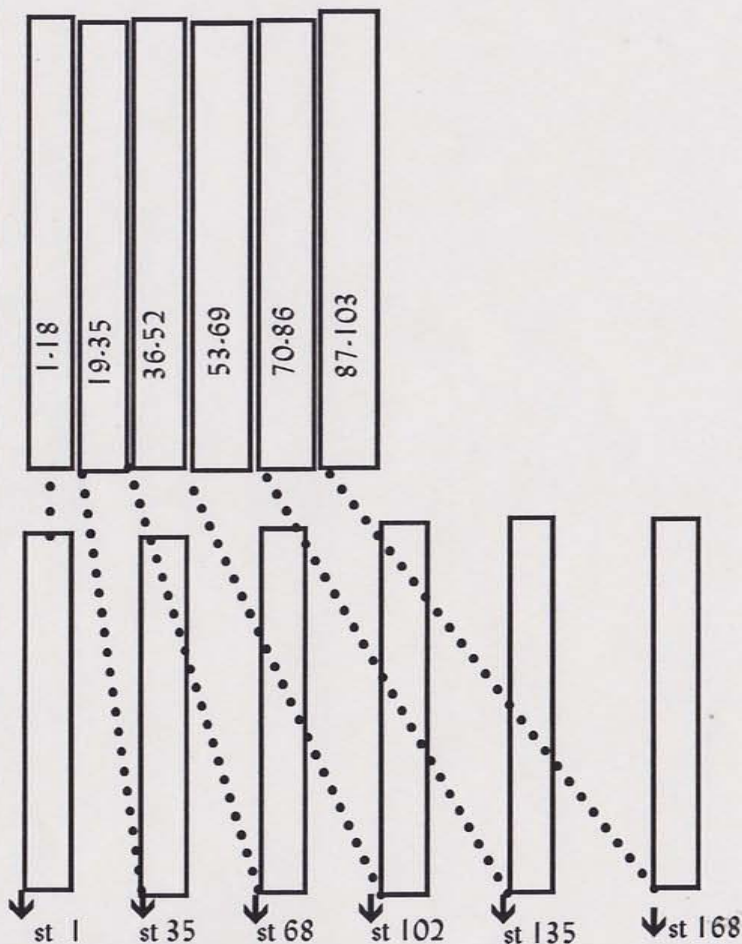
- ✓ *With arrow keys frame the section that you will transfer. As you move the cursor you will see at the bottom of the screen the stitches and rows currently inside frame. You need 17 stitches by 200 rows for this pattern. (step)*
- The portion framed is gone from screen. *Move cursor to row 1, stitch 168. Use #3, reduce, to check that placement looks correct. (step) Study diagram at right and follow dotted lines to see where each section goes.*
- ✓ Pattern appears. *Use #3 again to show whole design to check placement. Choose #1 to place pattern.*
- *Help menu: #9 to transfer (step). You will see "set corner." Arrow to row 1, stitch 70, and frame 17st by 200 rs. (step)*
- ✓ *Move cursor to row 1, stitch 135 (step) I usually use #3 to reduce the design so that I can check each time I make a transfer.*

Note: Look at the diagram at right to see the placement of the remaining columns of stitches. You are transforming a pattern that looks like the one on page 7 to a pattern that looks like the pattern on page 8.

When you are using the PPD, you will start with the section to the far right of the first pattern, stitches 87 to 103. Those stitches will be placed with the lower left corner on stitch 168 of the new grid.

The needles on both beds are set up according to diagram page 14. The skirt is knit in same manner as the model skirt is knit.

Example: Stitches 87 to 103 will become stitches 168 to 185 on new grid. Notice that stitches 186 to 200 remain blank.



THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT

KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

**SHORTCUTS**

⇒ Simple Method for Designing Pleats

- ☐ Set up the needles for the pleats as you did for the more elaborate design.
- ☐ Pick a small repeat design from Stitch World. Number 7 and 11 will also look quite nice.
- ☐ Use KRC setting on your machine for the double jacquard, and the cast on of your choice. Follow the directions for your machine for knitting jacquard, especially the sequence for knitting the background and contrast colors. Check after 30 rows or so to be sure you aren't knitting stripes. It all should be the same as the directions for this pattern, except that the color memo will be somewhat different.
- ☐ Do remember that this method will not give a continuous or matching pattern across the pleats.

⇒ Here's an example of a design drawn quickly in Deluxe Paint.

If your machine can't use a 200 needle design, this kind of design can be broken into the pleats without sacrificing much in continuity. Set the machine for all over patterning and double jacquard knitting. Set up the pleats as in the diagram page 14.



GOOD LUCK!
HAVE FUN

YOU'RE DONE !

DESIGN YOUR OWN — LEAFLET # 3
THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT
KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

VERY IMPORTANT
NOTES ON ENTERING DATA INTO MACHINE

All the stitch patterns should appear on your needle bed in the same placement as you see them in the inverted print out or the mylar template. In other words, there should be 17 or 18 needles on the right end of needle bed that do not select for pattern. These are the stitches that will be transferred to the ribber bed. On Brother/KnitKing machines the set-up is easy to see, as the selected needles come forward.

On the DesignaKnit™ disk, the original *newsprt2* pattern has the blank stitch columns on the on the left as you see it on the computer screen), and this is the placement that you need to load to your Brother machines. When this design is called up for interactive knitting, the design is inverted so that the blank stitch columns are on right. This happens because of a switch that toggles “on” or “off” to invert knitted piece so that you are looking at the purl side. If the design isn’t correct, use Modify/Shuffle to shift stitches in pattern 17 sts to the right. That will put blank stitch columns on the left. Now go back to interactive knitting to make sure the blank columns now are on the right where they should be. Then load your pattern into your machine.

On the 940 Brother disk, there are 6 patterns. Number 902 is the one to use for Brother/KnitKing. The remaining patterns are there in case your machine inverts patterns differently.

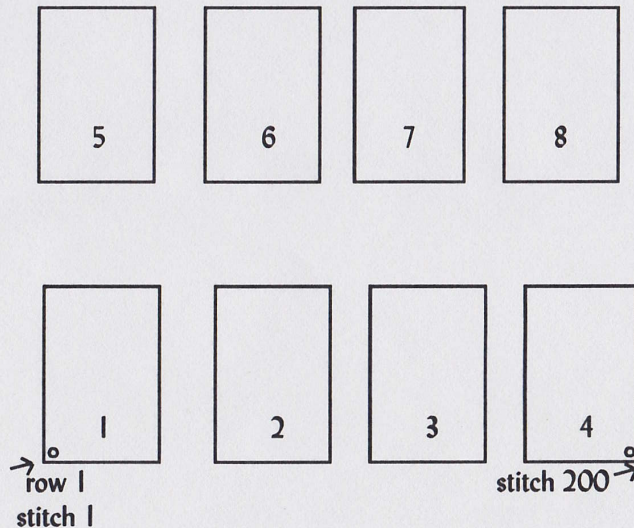
Correct placement needs to be checked before knitting, as it is cumbersome to accomodate all the different types of loading mechanisms in the different machines. However, most machines will place the pattern as if you were looking at the purl side of the knitting (inverted). This will usually be correct.

NOTES ON USING THE STITCH TEMPLATE

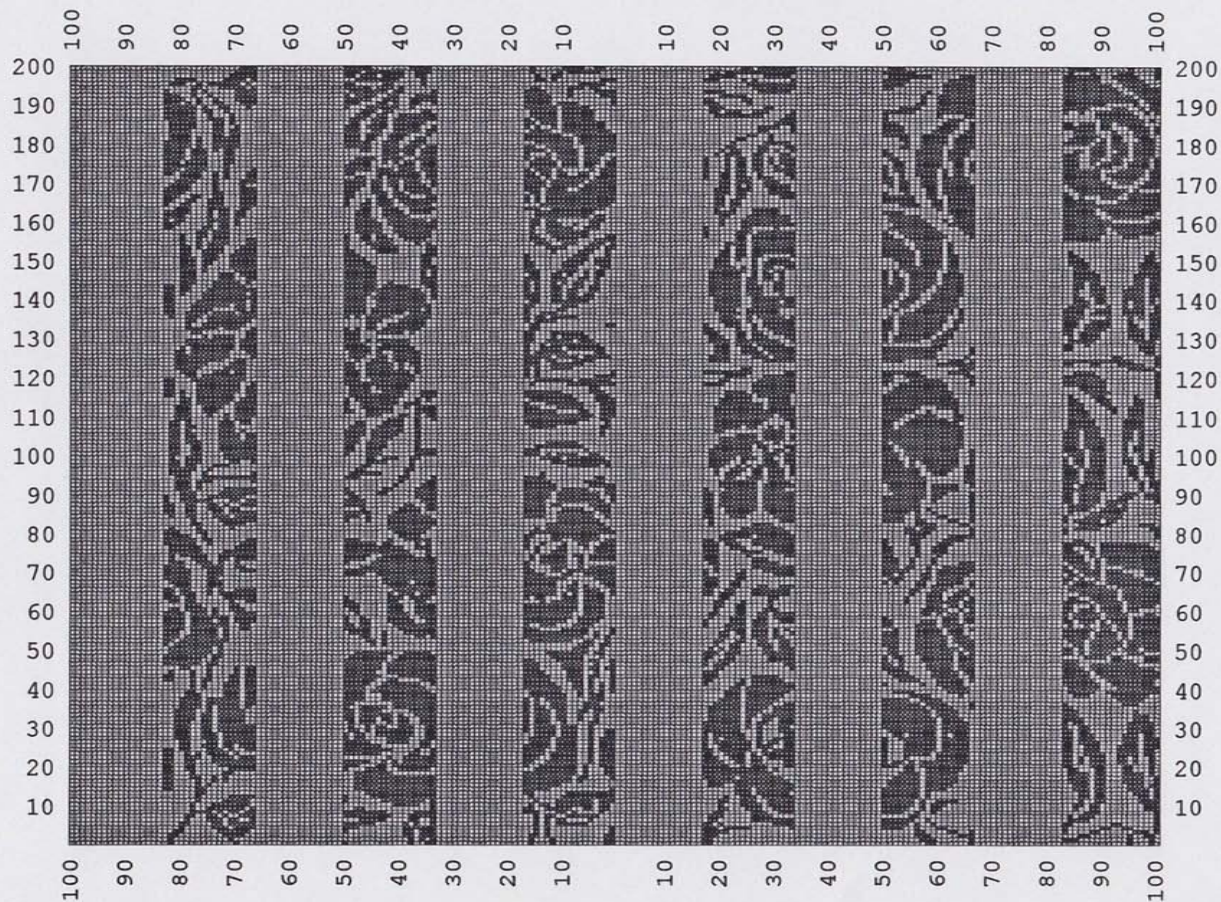
The template can be used for directly copying the pattern onto the Brother mylar or the Studio equivalent. The template can also be used for entering the stitches on the black/white keys on the Brother 940 machines and their equivalents.

For most cases, you will find that it is helpful to cut and paste the pages together, aligning the edges accurately. Brother 950i machines read the cards in consecutive order as diagrammed below. See your instruction manual for directions.

Paste pages together in order below.



DESIGN YOUR OWN — LEAFLET # 3
 THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT
 KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD
 printed inverted right to left

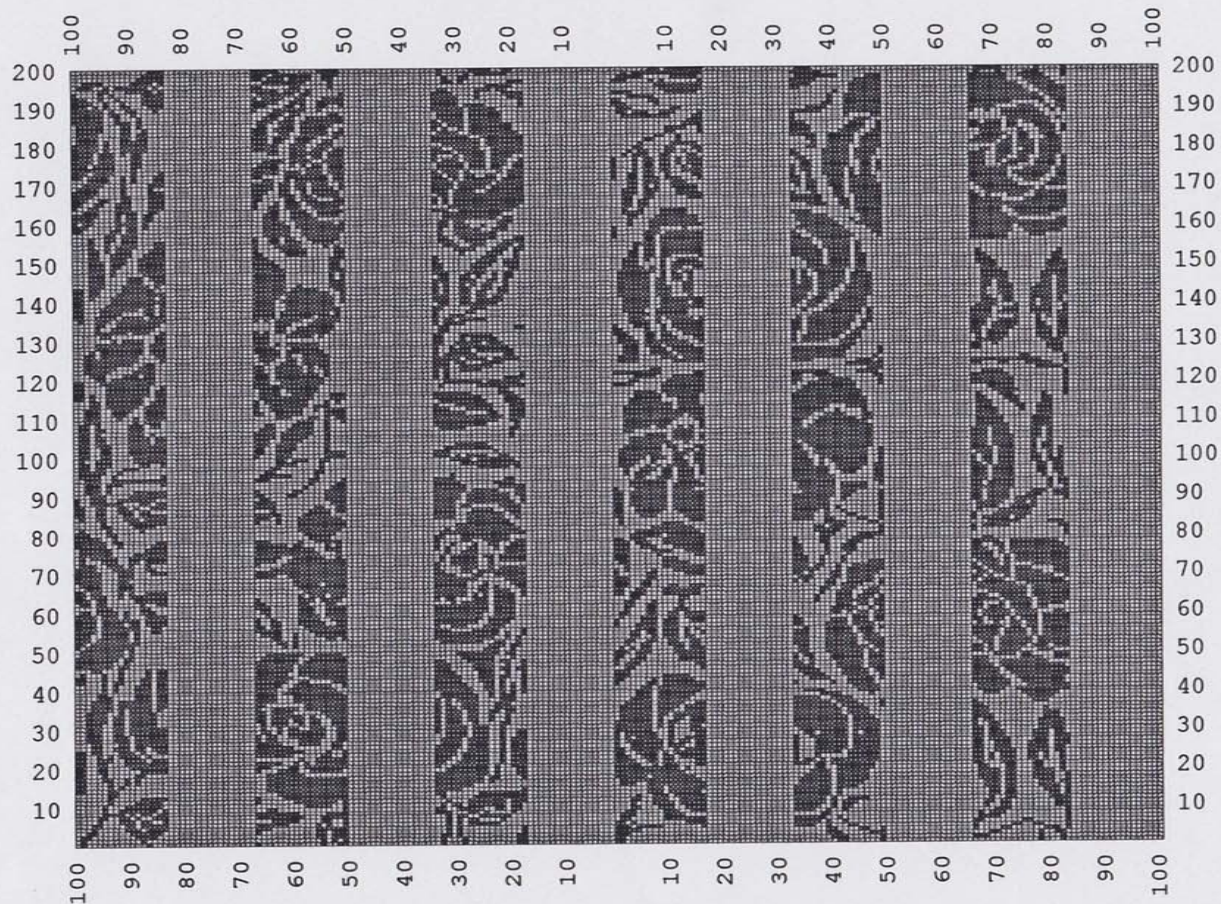


DesignaKnit™ Stitch Pattern Picture newskrt.pat

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THE ULTIMATE PLEATED SKIRT
KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

printed inverted left to right



DesignaKnit™ Stitch Pattern Picture newskrt2.pat —

Use this version for interactive knitting. Empty stitches should be on right end of needle bed.

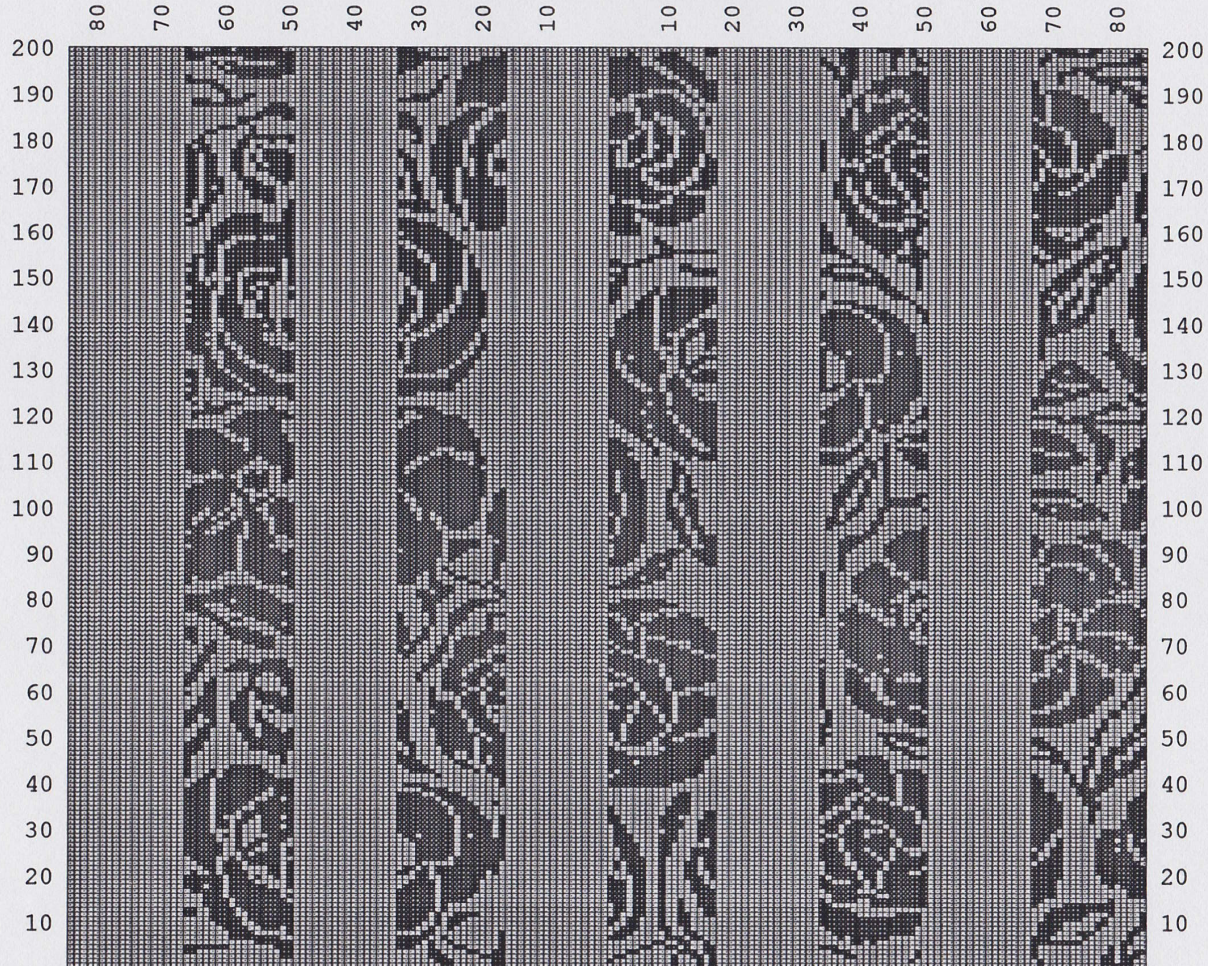
(Brother 940 disk #902 - From disk and PPD pattern will load as above. Use this version to load from disk.)

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KNIFE PLEATS IN DOUBLE JACQUARD

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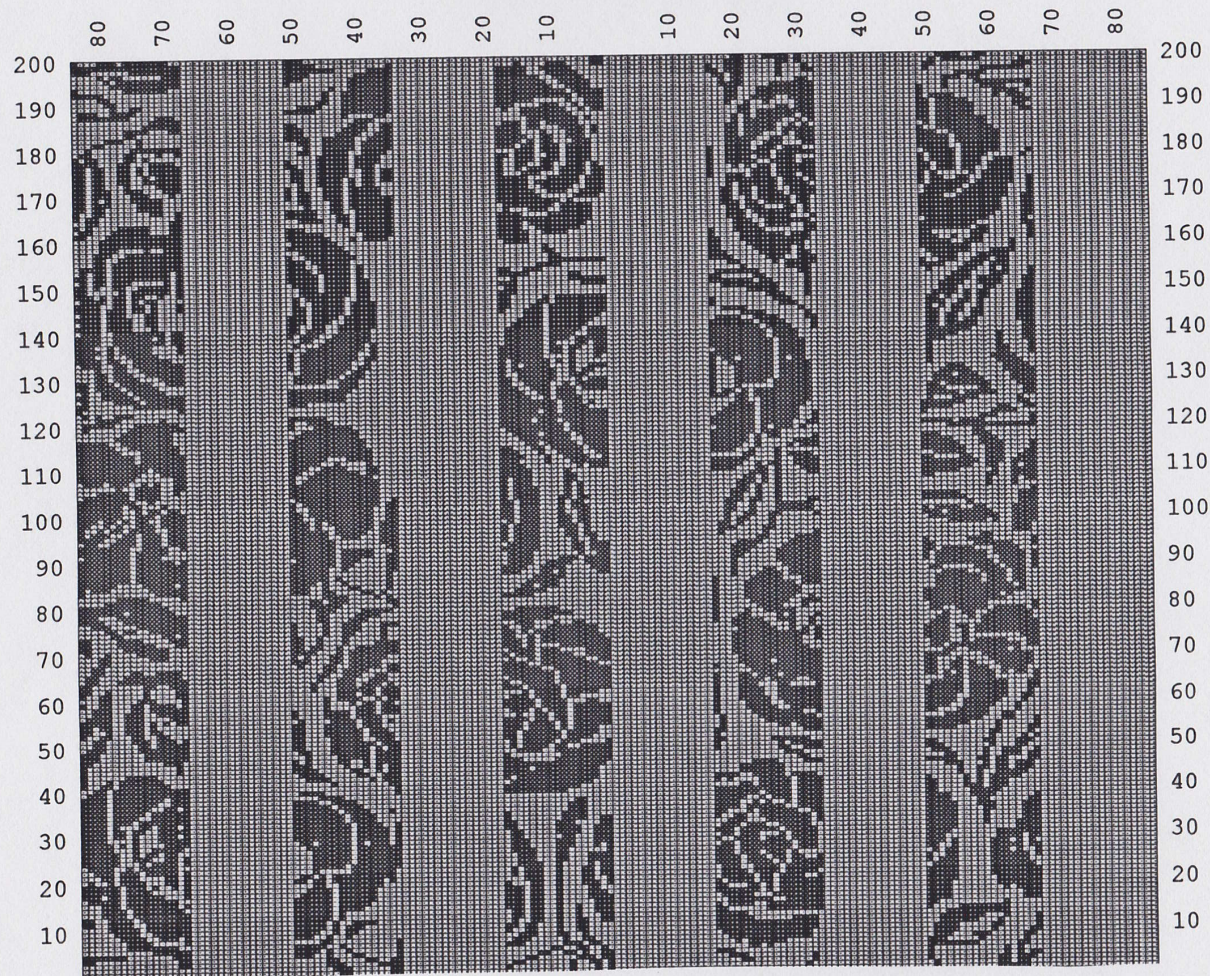
DesignaKnit™ Stitch Pattern Picture passplt.pat

(Brother 940 disk #904 - From disk and PPD. pattern will load as above.)

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DesignaKnit™ Stitch Pattern Picture passplt2.pat

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